

Day 01 - Thursday 06/25/2026

Sunday, April 13, 2025 3:17 PM

FLIGHT FROM SACRAMENTO TO DUBLIN :
SMF, Sacramento - DFW, Dallas/Fort Worth

We both got up early in order to finalize our packing and get ready. Andrea picked us up at 8:00 am to take us to the airport.

Everything at the airport went smoothly, including the check through TSA. At TSA, there was no wait. First time that has happened. The flight was pretty uneventful although we got to Dallas early and had to wait on the tarmac until we could get to the gate for about 20 minutes. That put us back on the same time schedule.

Day 02 - Friday 06/26/2026

Sunday, January 11, 2026 4:30 PM

FLIGHT: DFW, Dallas/Fort Worth - DUB, Dublin

The flight to Dublin was also pretty uneventful, although it was a lot longer flight. 8 or so hours is just about the limit these days. Also the time and day changed from Thursday to Friday (06/26/2026).

Once in Dublin, we took the Dublin Express to get to Heuston where the train station is located. There was a long line to get on the bus, but there was plenty of room. Supposed to have been about a half hour but it was more like 45 minutes. There were a number of stops that the bus had to make and what seemed like a lot of backtracking due to one-way streets. Anyway, we had plenty of time and ended up waiting at the train station for our train to arrive.

Once we figured out which car to get into, we found our seats by the seat numbers 7 and 8. But there was no confirmation number and we had asked that they not print our name. Turns out after much discussion, we sat where we were but they had actually printed our confirmation number for the two seats behind us. The ticket checker didn't even to bother to check, so it didn't really matter.

The train to Waterford was about 2 hours long. The train was quiet until some group got on who were obvious soccer fans. They were an older crowd, male and female, and were very loud and raucous. They, apparently, were going to Waterford too. The train was going great until we stopped in Kilkenny. Then the train reversed direction, which made no sense until we realized that it needed to do so to get to Waterford. Going to Kilkenny was an offshoot and the train had to go on a different track to get to Waterford.

Waterford

The Granville Hotel (check-in)
Meagher Quay, Waterford, X91 KC84 Ireland

The hotel is nice. Has some wonderful and historic charm to it. Some good Waterford crystal too as part of the décor. It was just a short walk over the bridge and down to the hotel.

We ended up resting a bit and then headed out to get a feel for the town. The town of Waterford is not that big so it didn't take us long. We ended up back at the hotel.

We then headed out for some dinner. The restaurant here at the Granville was technically experiencing problems so food and drink was cash only. So we walked down to the Dooley Hotel and had dinner at their Dooley Dry Dock. The food was good. I had the Guinness Beef Stew and Janet had the Fish and Chips. Of course, without the mushy peas.

We finished up and made our way (a short distance) back to the hotel and called it a night about 8:00 pm, local time. We had been up over 24 hours.

THINGS TO DO:

House of Waterford Crystal
Dooley's Hotel - Dry Dock Bar
Lismore Castle
Waterford Shore Valley Railway
Viking triangle and museums
 King of the Vikings
 Reginald's Tower
 Christ Church Cathedral

Day 03 - Saturday 06/27/2026

Monday, January 12, 2026 9:23 AM

Waterford

The hotel is nice but has thin walls. So the noise from the couple next door kept us up. We were still adjusting to the jet lag so it wasn't too bad. They are the typical Irish couple who talks a lot and loudly. So, it was a bit noisy. They also kept their TV on all night. Their talking was loud and one (we think the guy) kept leaving the room and slamming the door. Either going down to the bar or outside for a cigarette. Hope they are not there tonight.

We had decided to pay the extra \$15 each for the breakfast. It was quite good and we met a couple from Michigan that we got some ideas from. Janet had the traditional Irish breakfast and I had the Eggs Benedict. Pastries and other cold items were buffet style. Everything was very good. We decided to go one more morning getting the breakfast.

From breakfast we dressed for wet weather and headed to the Waterford company for their factory tour. The Waterford crystal story and product is quite fascinating. It was well worth the price. The tour takes through the factory, starting at the very beginning and ending with the finished product. It was raining pretty good once we were done.

Afterwards, we decided not to purchase the pass to all the museums and, instead, just decided to go to a couple on our own. The best one was the Time Museum. Clocks from all over but mainly wind up clocks and watches. The final section was over 400 cuckoo clocks. It was pretty warm up in the room with the cuckoo clocks. Again, well worth the price of admission.

We then went back to the hotel to go prone for awhile. In the mean time, Janet decided to go to another museum, the Irish Wake museum. I decided to stay in the room and rest. The maid finally came about 2:00 pm to make up the room so I went downstairs to wait for Janet. She showed up about 3:00 pm. We decided to go out and get something to drink.

We looked for Murphy's but couldn't find any pub that had it. We ended up at the Dooley Hotel (Dooley Dry Dock) where I had a Guinness and Janet had a white wine. We were watching what we thought was cricket, but it turns out it was hurling. Not familiar with that one but it was similar to soccer but with a stick and a much smaller ball. Seems like they have a sport and tv coverage for everything.

Now we are back at the hotel where they were very apologetic about the noise from the air conditioner. Said it did need fixing but that would not happen until next Monday (it is now Saturday). It is really not that bad but they were certainly much better at handling the situation than what you would find in the States.

We went to dinner at a pub that was supposed to have good lobster rolls. Turns out this night they didn't have lobster rolls but we stayed anyway. Janet had the crab and I had the fish and chips. Both were good and the fish and chips was not fishy like it was the first time out. After dinner we went back to the hotel, did some reading and went to bed. Hopefully, not as noisy as last night.

Day 04 - Sunday 06/28/2026

Monday, January 12, 2026 9:24 AM

Waterford

Well, another sleepless night due to the neighbors next door and their soccer obsession. Finally, about 1:30 am Janet called down to the front desk about the noise and it came to a stop. But until then, no sleep!

Going to Kilkenny for the day. First, breakfast downstairs, on the house, due to the inconvenience of the air conditioner. But it doesn't make up for the unwanted noise and little sleep. They have decided to move us to another room but we won't know what is until we get back later.

We decided to take the train to Kilkenny but after walking to the train station we found out the train was leaving at 12:00 pm instead of 11:00 am. It was because the day is Sunday and the train doesn't leave for Kilkenny until 12:00 pm on Sunday. Janet walked back to the bus station to see if we could still catch the 11:00 am bus. I stayed put at the train station. Janet came back and we walked back to the bus station and caught a bus at 11:00 am to Kilkenny.

Kilkenny is a nice town with plenty of things to see and do. The main attraction is the Kilkenny Castle which was close by where we got off of the bus. It is almost like a mini Windsor castle with a big public lawn area heading up to the castle. We didn't need to go inside.

We stopped into a pub to get something to drink. I was still looking for a Murphy's beer and Janet finally found it here at Lanigan's Bar or pub. So we stopped here to have a bite to eat and get something to drink. I had the Murphy's beer and Janet got some kind of whiskey foo foo drink. We shared a cottage pie (made with beef), which is really the same thing as a Shepherd's pie (made with lamb). Everything was very good.

We had been told by a person in Waterford that there was a Murphy's Ice Cream place here in Kilkenny but that was a no go. She had recommended the brown bread ice cream but we will have to wait until we get to Dublin.

We walked around town until it was time to catch the train back to Waterford. We ended up on the train back to Dublin, instead of Waterford. So the ticket person on the train said to get off the train at Carlow and wait for the real train to Waterford. So that's what we did, along with some other people who did the same thing. Anyway, we did so and ended up in Waterford about 2 hours later than we expected.

We walked back to the Granville hotel from the Waterford train station and retrieved the keys to our new room. It is up on the fifth floor and is much bigger than what we had before. It is the so-called honeymoon suite. So, hopefully, we can get some sleep.

Since we had a late lunch earlier, we didn't need dinner. We enjoyed the larger room and went to bed. Quiet for a change.

Day 05 - Monday 06/29/2026

Monday, January 12, 2026 9:25 AM

The Granville Hotel (check-out)

Woke up this morning after a good night's sleep but the internet connection is very weak and intermittent. Must be because we are on the top floor.

Overall, the Granville was a good choice. Good breakfast and nice room. But the noisy neighbors kind of ruined it.

The big question became how to get to Doolin? We ended up having to take most of the day to get there.

We started with the bus out of Waterford. That bus took us to Limerick where we de-bussed and got on another bus that took us to Ennus. There, we de-bussed again and got on a local bus that got us to Doolin. Fortunately, the hotel is the bus stop in Doolin. Overall, it was nice to see the countryside.

Weather is off and on again rain. Hit and miss really. Not bad though. Everyone (the locals) is complaining about the heat they had previously. Not happening now, but expected to return next week.

Doolin

Hotel Doolin (check-in)

Fitzcross, Doolin, Clare, 0 Ireland

The Doolin Hotel is probably one of the nicest stops we have had. The room is actually a suite and includes breakfast. The room also has one of those electric fireplaces that we first saw in Delft. It runs by lights and water that creates steam that makes it look like smoke. Nothing gets hot though and thus no heat provided. But the ambiance is very nice. I think it is made by Fabor.

It's kind of a green place but the room itself is very modern with nice optional plugs at each outlet. It has two attached restaurants, pizza themed and pub themed. Close to everything we want to do. Such as the Cliffs of Moher.

We ate dinner at the pub. Found another Murphy's beer. Food was good.

Day 06 - Tuesday 06/30/2026

Monday, January 12, 2026 9:27 AM

Doolin

Had a good night's sleep. We will ask for smaller pillows though as we both woke up with stiff necks. Just waiting to see how the breakfast is. Weather is off and on again rain, but it's all good. It is rather windy.

Breakfast was ok. Not any good pastries. There was a little dry scone, small chocolate twist and a single, plain croissant. Some yogurt and small (very small smoothy). Then, one hot item such as eggs or pancake (just one). Not bad, but could be better. Like there was no juice. No good selection of pastries, even though they are next door to a bakery.

We then walked the path along the Cliffs of Moher. Didn't realize that it was 6 miles round trip. So about 1.5 miles in I turned back to the hotel. Janet kept going as far as she could. Turns out she went most of the way and was not impressed.

After she got back and rested (which for her was just a few minutes) we took the bus (turns out it was free and included a free entrance fee) to the Cliffs of Moher Visitor Center. Much better view of the cliffs and there was even the first live sighting of Puffins for Janet. But it was very windy and occasional rain. The visitor center was very nice though. The puffins were very far away, but still. Even with my long lens and binoculars they were still quite small.

We are back at the hotel now just waiting for dinner. Pizza tonight. Well, we went to the pizza place here owned by the hotel and is not the best experience. It took forever to get our pizza and the explanation was that we got a starter (salad). When asked if we wanted the salad with dinner or before. Since we wanted it delivered before, that meant it was a starter. That meant that they didn't even start the pizza until after we were through with the salad, which came late by the way. Anyway, we sat there as other people around us who ordered later than we did, received their salad and pizza before us. They tried to comp us but they obviously needed to fix the problem not just hope the problem goes away. The pizza place is run by the same guy who runs the pub so guess where the problem is?

Anyway, we finally returned to our room to get ready for bed. We did get new pillows that are smaller so hopefully that will help with the sleeping.

Day 07 - Wednesday 07/01/2026

Monday, January 12, 2026 9:28 AM

Doolin

Slept better last night with the smaller pillows. The stiffness in the necks seems to be lessening. We did wake up fairly early though. More like at home around 5:00 am.

Went down for our free breakfast again. Same cold stuff, not that great. The hot portion is pretty limited. I had the porridge and Janet had some eggs. This morning they served toast and bread while yesterday there was none. There was juice, but you had to know it was there, as they don't do a very good job of advertising it.

We got a visit from some manager who apologized for last night's dinner. I was a bit surprised that everyone apparently knew about it. They were still trying to apologize rather than fix the problem.

We went on our boat trip to the smallest of the islands. It was quite miserable as the wind was very strong and the waves very large. Once we were on the island we took a horse drawn ride around the very small island. It was all we could do to stay warm and dry. There were 4 other tourists in the small carriage all trying to get out of the weather. At the end of the ride, we had to pay the driver in cash. So we had to go into a pub, order something and get cash back in order to pay the driver.

We were supposed to cruise around the Cliffs of Moher but we didn't go because the waves were too big and you couldn't see anything anyway because of the weather.

After resting back at the hotel room, we walked back a ways to Gus's Pub for dinner. I had chicken and Janet had the seafood chowder. The pub was a typical Irish pub, not much different than what we had experienced elsewhere.

We returned to the room, checked the internet and prepared for bed.

Day 08 - Thursday 07/02/2026

Monday, January 12, 2026 9:29 AM

Hotel Doolin (check-out)

Overall, the Doolin Hotel is very nice, as long as you get the suite. The attached restaurants are iffy, at best. Weather is a big factor in what you can and can't do. There always seems to be a wind but the rain is mostly light or misty.

This morning we take the bus to Galway and from there the train to Dublin. It was a long day but so much simpler than how we got to Doolin. We woke up kind of early and used the two tickets that the hotel gave us to get a coffee and pastry at the bakery next door. They did this since we were going to miss our last free breakfast. The coffee was good although the pastry wasn't up to par. Still the same lack of flavor and taste. My cinnamon roll was mainly dough and a little overcooked. But the room was great!

Dublin

Hyatt Centric The Liberties Dublin (check-in)
Dean St, The Liberties, Dublin Ireland

THINGS TO DO:

- Guinness Brewery
- Jameson's Whiskey Distillery
- Grafton Street
- Dublin Castle
- St. Patrick's Cathedral

We arrived at the hotel late afternoon so we're able to check into our room. We have the handicapped room, so its bigger but next to the elevators. We shall see how the night goes.

We looked at price of admission to the Guinness Store for tomorrow. The price significantly higher than today, so we decided to for it today. As tired as we were we went to get our Guinness fix.

At the Guinness Store we took the self-guided tour, which included a tasting lesson and a pint of Guinness at the end up on the 7th floor. The view from there is incredible and the Guinness topped it off. It was very crowded at the top, but we eventually found a table for two by the window. We finished up with a meal on the 5th floor just to get something substantial in our bodies.

We the headed back to our room to get ready for bed.

Day 09 - Friday 07/03/2026

Monday, January 12, 2026 9:30 AM

Dublin

Woke up early again about 5:00 am. Room is ok but the air conditioning seems to go to off during the night. Had to open a window this morning. Janet had gone to the store last night before bed and got some rolls and juice, so it was nice to have this morning. The coffee is ok at best. We will be going out soon for something better.

Janet talked to the front desk about our room not having a king bed, even though we paid for one. They are going to give us free breakfast for the rest of our stay.

We left this morning to tour the things we were going to be doing. We stopped early and had some coffee and apple cake with real whipped cream. Very good and tasty. We then proceeded to find the other items on our list. Those being the Temple Bar area and bar, St. Patrick's Church, Dublin Castle, Grafton Street and Murphy's Ice Cream. Took us a few hours and then we headed back to our hotel. I rested and Janet rested a little and then headed out on her own for awhile.

We ate and drank at Temple Bar. Some musicians were playing, but the place was very crowded. More beer.

Murphy's Ice Cream wasn't really as good as advertised. Very small hole in the wall and the brown bread ice cream was ok but not great. Overall, just a local ice cream place.

Grafton Street was really just a high end version of Temple Bar. Nothing of interest there.

After Janet came back we rested some more then headed out. We were given a discount ticket downstairs to Teeling Whiskey Distillery. It was only supposed to be close by but we had trouble finding it. Finally, there it was. We decided we didn't want the tour but would do a tasting. Three samples. Boy were they strong. Anyway, we didn't like them very much.

We went to dinner at a recommended place, The Landmark. We went early because we knew that the World Soccer was on tonight. The dinner was ok, but as we were leaving the noise level was definitely going up. Some local or tourist guys were starting the night early.

We returned to the hotel, listened to some music and then went upstairs to prepare for bed.

Day 10 - Saturday 07/04/2026

Monday, January 12, 2026 9:31 AM

Dublin

Woke up this morning around 5:00 am ready to start the day. In-room coffee is not that great. We will see how the breakfast is here at the hotel. Our theory is that the bigger the hotel chain is, the less real service you get. Here at the Hyatt you would expect them to get things right, but no. The card key didn't work in the elevator to get to the upper floors. Why would it work in the door? Why is room 530 not down the hallway that guides you to rooms 529-532? Why did we get to a handicap room with only a queen bed when we booked for a king bed? Why can't the waiter or waitress get their own water to the table instead of going through the bar? Just some examples of what we have seen at the larger hotels.

Today we hope to get to Jameson's Whiskey Distillery and Brazen Head Bar. First Janet walked to the streets she wanted to go to by herself. She was gone about 2 hours.

Upon her return, she rested up a bit then we headed out to eventually end up at Jameson's Whiskey. We walked across the river to a shopping mall we had not been to. There was a tall, spiral monument called The Spire. We stopped so could get a bite to eat. From there we walked to Jameson's.

We took the tour, which was better than the tour at Guinness, but not good as the Johnny Walker tour in Belfast, but Jameson's does have better tasting whiskey.

From there we walked to Brazen Head Bar for dinner. Fish and Chips and the Guinness Stew. The Guinness Stew was typical but the Fish and Chips was pretty dry tasting. Every place seems to make it differently.

Walked back to our room to prepare for the usual bed routine. Before going to bed though, we went down stairs to listen to some music.

Day 11 - Sunday 07/05/2026

Monday, January 12, 2026 9:32 AM

Hyatt Centric The Liberties Dublin (check-out)

The hotel is in a very good location to things you might want to see in Dublin. The hotel itself is a little hard to find. For such a large hotel brand it can be a little frustrating. They can't seem to get the little things right.

Like this morning. Coffee maker stopped working. Putting out only water.

Taking Dublin Express bus to airport. First grab some food downstairs where we are supposed to have free breakfast buffet.

FLIGHT: Dublin, Ireland to Reykjavik, Iceland

The flight from Dublin was ok. You do have to wait quite a long time (over an hour) in line to check in with Icelandair.

Once you get to the airport in Iceland you can take the FlyBus to Reykjavik. The bus will take you to the bus terminal and from there you take smaller buses to get to your designated hotel. No extra charge, just a bit of a hassle.

Reykjavik (check-in)

Hotel Reykjavík Grand
Sigtun 28, Reykjavik, 105 Iceland

Everything here is pretty new and modern. That includes the Hotel Reykjavik Grand. The weather was in the high 60's F so the room was a little warm. There is no air conditioning or climate control in the room. So, the single window (which operates electronically) is all you have. Things are VERY expensive here.

Day 12 - Monday 07/06/2026

Monday, January 12, 2026 9:34 AM

Hotel Reykjavík Grand (check-out)

Woke up in the morning early. Janet had gone out the night before and gotten something to eat for dinner and breakfast. I was able to walk part way but had to turn back to the hotel early. Janet kept going. The in-room coffee is so so, as usual.

Checkout is 12 noon, so we will do some sightseeing before heading to the port for embarkation. Any time after 11:00 am but stateroom availability for us (since we are in a deluxe veranda room) is 2:00 pm

VIKING CRUISE - Embarkation

We spent the morning walking around Reykjavik trying to see the things we had planned to do and see. We went back to the hotel and rested a bit before heading to the cruise terminal.

Monday, July 6, 2026 To Monday, July 13, 2026
Skarfabakki Cruise Pier- Skarfagoroum 8, Reykjavik

Reykjavik, Iceland

We sailed through the check-in process for Viking after having walked about 3 miles. Check-in was fairly easy, but you do have to go through a security screening, similar to TSA.

We were given a glass of champagne and were put through our muster and headed up to deck 7 for lunch. We ate some salad and a slice of pizza and had our wine.

We were trying to scope out the ship but decided to go to our room, as they announced that all staterooms were ready. Our room is a tiny bit smaller than the one on Oceania, but it is a smaller ship. We watched the mandatory TV video on safety.

After getting all our stuff in our room situated, we headed to dinner at The Restaurant, which is the main dining room. We arrived before the opening at 6:00 pm but it was starting to get crowded. We got a table by the window but it was on the port side. No view. So we switched to another window table on the starboard side, which faced the ocean. Much nicer.

After dinner we stopped and listened to some piano before heading back to our stateroom to finalize our room and get ready for bed.

Day 13 - Tuesday 07/07/2026

Monday, January 12, 2026 12:40 PM

VIKING CRUISE

Reykjavik

Viking Paid: Golden Circle Excursion: 8:00 AM to 4:30 PM

Reykjavik is in the Esja mountain range. The striking Hallgrímskirkja church stands in the city center, while the glass Harpa concert hall is an example of modern architecture. Reykjavik is also the site of the meeting between Ronald Reagan and Mikhail Gorbachev, which marked the beginning of the end of the Cold War.

Woke up early but got a good night's sleep. Coffee in the room is ok. Going to breakfast at the World Café, which is really the buffet, about 7:00 am. Kind of typical food for the buffet. The pastry leaves a lot to be desired.

We had our Golden Circle excursion which lasted entire day mostly by us. Got back around 5:00 pm. It rained most of the day and the wind was very strong as well.

The first stop was at the geothermal place. This is where they generate geothermal energy as part of the 25 percent of Iceland's capacity besides hydropower, wind and fossil fuels. We visited the On Power plant that provides electricity and hot water to Reykjavik. They make it possible for very cheap electricity, water and heating.

Next we stopped at the Gullfoss waterfall. It was VERY windy and cold with rain but it was still good to get off of the bus. We also stopped and had lunch, which was also a buffet style.

Lastly, we stopped at the National Park to visit the Geyser. Not as high or predictable as the one in Yellowstone, but still worth it.

Overall, it was just really good to watch the scenery from the bus. Plenty of Icelandic horses and sheep along the way.

We ended up back at the ship around 5:00 pm. We had dinner scheduled at the Chef's Table which is where they pair the wine with the menu. The menu changes every couple of days. Today it was Asian themed and we sat at table with 4 other people. The people were nice and friendly, but the food really wasn't that great. Good coconut prawns though. We talked mainly with a Tom and Linda, but also with Nick and Lisa.

After dinner we went up to the World Café and I got some ice cream or gelato. I'm not really sure what. Good touch to ending the night.

We returned to our room and prepared for bed. It is fairly rocky tonight, although not too bad.

Day 14 - Wednesday 07/08/2026

Monday, January 12, 2026 12:41 PM

VIKING CRUISE

Isafjordur

Viking Included: Isafjordur & Bolungarvik Village: 8:30 AM to 10:30 AM.

Isafjordur, nestled at the foot of dramatic mountain slopes, is the capital and largest settlement on the Westfjords. Landscapes include cascading waterfalls and Drangajokull, Iceland's only expanding glacier. The Westfjords teem with birdlife.

Woke up early again and ended up at the Word Café for breakfast again. Had our morning in-room coffee. Still a little rocky, but as we headed down the fjord it got quite calm. Weather is better today, although still overcast and threatening.

We then proceeded with our free tour from Viking through the stop at Isafjordur. We actually had three stops. One was to listen to a local guitarist. Then to listen to a local fisherman resurrecting his role as an historic fisherman. Third was to a small waterfall where we also tasted the fresh, local water. The tour itself was very nice.

We are now back on the ship catching up on some outstanding items before lunch.

Janet headed back into town from the ship to do some shopping. She came back empty handed around noon, just in time to have some lunch.

After lunch we waited around for a while until there was a lecture about our next stop in Akureyri. We attended that and found out there was a small get together, so we went and got some free champagne. After that Janet wanted to shop some on-board, so she did that and I headed back to the room until dinner.

We were going to eat at the main restaurant, but Janet noticed that the World Café had shrimp and king crab legs. So, of course, we went for the shrimp and king crab. Even I had my fill and topped it off with a good dessert.

We met up with Tom and Linda from last night and ate our shrimp and crab. We also briefly talked with Nick and Lisa before heading up to our room to get ready for bed.

Day 15 - Thursday 07/09/2026

Monday, January 12, 2026 12:42 PM

VIKING CRUISE

Akureyri

Viking Included: Panorama Akureyri: 9:00 AM to 10:45 AM.

Viator: Godafoss Waterfall Shore Excursion: From Akureyri Port: 1:00 PM to 3:00 PM.

Itinerary Number: 1366123747

Booking Reference: BR-1366123747

Excursion From Akureyri Port

Akureyri Cruise Terminal, MWMF+X4H, Laufásgata, Akureyri, Iceland

Meet at the car park on the Pier where your ship docks. This will be either Oddeyrarbryggja Pier car park or Tangabryggja Pier car park. Look for our sign with 'Imagine Iceland Travel'.

Nicknamed the "Capital of the North", Akureyri is set at the end of the Eyjafjörður and enjoys a mild climate. Points of pride are the Public Park, the Botanic Garden and Akureyrarkirkja, the local church that is home to a stained glass window that originated in a church in London, prior to World War II.

Woke up this morning again early. Had our morning in-room coffee. The sun is out, in parts, so that's a good sign. I did see a couple of dolphins as we were floating along towards Akureyri. This is the second morning where it took a LONG time to get hot water in the shower. Don't know if it is because I am the first (it is kind of early) or if that is just the way it is. Anyway, once it gets hot it is very hot.

We will be trying out Mamsen's this morning. This is where the waffles are supposed to be so good. They are very limited in their hours. The waffle was good and it was not crowded at all. It's the topping of fruit and a cheese that makes the waffle. Other than that it's just a clover-shaped waffle.

We were gliding along very smoothly and all of a sudden we are in this massive wind. The seas and the ship are definitely rocking.

As we entered the fjord, the wind died down and the seas calmed.

The Viking included tour was about two hours by bus. It stopped at a nursery that had some really nice flowers, etc.

The Viator tour went to Godafoss waterfall. It was also about two or three hours. The waterfall is nice, the weather was good, but windy. Quite the opposite of our other trip to Gullfoss waterfalls, where it was very wet and windy. No good pictures. But should be plenty here at Godafoss.

Came back to the ship for an early departure. Tonight they had a special BBQ by the pool and a band, etc. We had to take our food and eat in the World Café, it was so crowded. Then we went back by the pool to listen to the music and play along with the game of name that tune. At the very end there was a whale sitting so that got everyone excited about that, rather than the game.

After that we headed to our room to get ready for bed.

Day 16 - Friday 07/10/2026

Monday, January 12, 2026 12:43 PM

VIKING CRUISE

Seydisfjordur

Viking Included: Seydisfjordur on Foot & Viking Festival: 10:00 AM to 12:00 PM.

Seydisfjordur is a mountainous setting at the end of a fjord. It traces its origin to the early days of Viking settlements.

Woke up early again. I had to take 1500 mg of Acetaminophen. Stiffness was getting to me. Janet got up and turned on the shower. I waited 10 or 15 minutes and still had to wait a few before I had enough hot water. Had our morning in-room coffee. We ate at World Café for breakfast.

We had a walking tour set up for this morning. Janet stayed but I went back to the ship after it started raining. I went up to the Explorer's Lounge to read and watch people. Janet came back after an hour or so. We sat around a bit, discussed the tour and then had lunch at the World Café. We then headed out to check out this waterfall. Nice little hike around this small little town of around 685 people.

On the way back Janet decided she needed to shop. So I went back to our room and Janet did some shopping. Tonight is Manfredi's.

Manfredi's was good. Good Italian and seafood. Seems to be a lot of choices. Of course, we missed the big lobster feast up in the World Café tonight. Was probably very crowded anyway (as it was for the BBQ).

Returned to our room and prepared for bed.

Day 17 - Saturday 07/11/2026

Monday, January 12, 2026 12:44 PM

VIKING CRUISE

Djupivogur

Viking Included: Cultural Sights of Djupivogur: 08:45 AM to 10:15 AM.

Djupivogur lies on Iceland's east coast and has been a trading center since the 16th century.

Tendering today. Woke up early, as usual. Had our morning in-room coffee. Heading to breakfast early as we have to tender to shore and catch our included walking tour of the town.

The walking tour was good. This place is very small, just over 600 people, so we didn't need a whole lot time. All the guides seem to know of stories and can repeat any number of stories. Small enough so that each house is named by its name, not a street address. First, we stopped at a place where the owner gathers and polishes his own stones. Our guide's wife performed a couple of traditional songs from inside of an old oil tanker. She also owned her own singing business. Seems as if everyone works couple of jobs, at least. Depends on the season what kind of job it is.

We learned about this island through the stories told by the guide. One of the stories had to do with what they call the hidden people. These are like ghosts but can become life-long friends. They tend to "see" these people and anyone missing is assumed to become one of the hidden people. It seems that the hidden people confirm what has already happened, rather than predicting what will happen.

I headed back to the ship, while Janet went off shopping.

Janet made it back to the ship before noon, so we had lunch in the World Café. Something mainly to get our wine or beer.

We are taking a little snooze now and will attend one of the lectures at 4:30 pm.

The 4:30 pm lecture was on our next port in Heimaey. Not so much on Heimaey but a lot on Viking excursions in Heimaey. Kind of boring actually.

Went to dinner at the Restaurant and had a pleasant meal by the window. Nice to have a change from the World Café.

Attended the show that celebrates the end of the cruise. Pretty amateur really. Although they did bring almost all of the staff on stage for recognition.

Then they did a show highlighting ABBA which was better but too long for my tastes.

Got to bed after 10:00 pm.

Day 18 - Sunday 07/12/2026

Monday, January 12, 2026 12:45 PM

VIKING CRUISE

Heimaey, Westman Islands

Viking Included: Snapshots of Heimaey: 01:30 PM to 03:00 PM. (We cancelled this since it conflicts with the other tour we arranged)

Viator Paid: Puffin and Volcano Tour with Ebbi: Puffin and Volcano Tour in

Vestmannaeyjar: 12:00 PM to 2:00 PM.

Eyjatours (You will find us at the harbor in a small black and blue house with Puffin signs above):

Start Point: Básaskersbryggja 8, 8, Básaskersbryggja, Vestmannaeyjar, Vestmannaeyjabær, Iceland

Heimaey is the only populated island in the Westman Islands. The scenery includes volcanic landscapes, moss covered clifftops, picturesque homes with brightly colored rooftops and a large settlement of puffins. Each summer, millions of puffins pay a visit to feed and breed.

Woke up this morning and it is pretty much fogged in. Since the weather changes so fast over here there is hope. But right now, at 7:00 am it doesn't look good for seeing puffins. But we don't dock until 10:00 am so we can only hope it improves. Actually we are not docking, we are tendering again.

We went up to Mamsen's for breakfast, specifically the waffles. Things are pretty fogged in still. Around 9:00 am we are supposed to have a lunch delivered so that we have something to eat while on our tour. Turns out it was a very small sandwich, two cookies and a very small apple.

Went down early to guest services to be assigned a tender to ride into town. Our Puffin tour doesn't start until 12:00 pm but we figured it would be better to get there early since we really didn't know how long the tendering would take. So we walked around town a bit and then sat on the small bus that would take us on our tour.

The tour itself was pretty good, a lot cheaper than the one Viking was offering. We stopped at numerous places, got off of the bus and were greeted with some pretty interesting sights. One of the stories, true in this case, had to do with the gathering of bird eggs. They always leave two in the nest, as this keeps the population going. One of the first stops was to show us the technique for getting the eggs off of a cliff. The person swings from a rope from nest to nest. Takes some skill and many tourists get hurt trying. The tour guide was heavily involved in where we stopped. One is where he established a museum that is a replica of houses as established from the archaeological record. He has been approached by Viking to work for them, but he prefers (and I'm sure happier) doing his own thing.

The puffins were the highlight. There were so many of them and so up close and personal. Hopefully, got some good and close-up pictures. Janet was thrilled.

We returned to the ship, had some lunch and went up to the Explorer Lounge to watch

the sea and cliffs.

We ended up having dinner with Tom and Linda in the World Café. We ate our dinner, had a good conversation and then said our goodbyes.

We went up to our room and prepared for bed.

Day 19 - Monday 07/13/2026

Monday, January 12, 2026 12:46 PM

VIKING CRUISE - Disembarkation

Getting up early so we can have breakfast and meet the taxi at 7:30 am.

We had a good breakfast, went back to the room and departed the ship. The taxi driver was prompt and took us to the airport. About 45 minutes away.

Met the taxi right on time. Made it to the airport on time.

Reykjavik, Iceland

FLIGHT: Reykjavik, Iceland to Sacramento, CA - Monday, July 13, 2026

Then the problems started. We had to wait for at least an hour in the Icelandair line in order to check our bags. Icelandair even had to open an extra stand from SAS in order to handle the crowd.

Then came TSA, which involved another long wait and long line. Then, for some odd reason, an even longer line where they apparently did some further security check.

By the time we were done, the gate for our flight was already boarding. Another long line and long wait. Up and down stairs.

The flight itself was without any free food or free drink. The only available free items were water and the restroom. The screen on the seat in front of you was available, but you had to pay for the earbuds.

We both vowed we would never fly Icelandair or go thru Iceland again.

Then was the flight to Denver. There, we had to go through Customs (which was fairly easy), but we had to retrieve our bags and manually turn them over to Southwest. Then, once again, we had to go through TSA. Again, by the time we were done, they were already boarding at the gate.

The flight itself was largely uneventful. The service was late because of turbulence but that wasn't Southwest's fault. What WAS Southwest's fault is that they lost both of our bags that were checked. Turns out they never left Denver. The good thing is, the luggage was delivered to our door at home.

Andrea met us at arrivals, without our luggage, and drove us home.

Although the house was very warm, it was nice to be in the comfort of our own home again.

We went to bed early, woke up early, found the luggage on the front porch and attempted to acclimate to our home environment.